MODULE 59 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Full Mock, Part Two

Part two of the 75-question mock. Same weighting, same pace: 60 minutes for 25 questions.

PART 2 of 3 QUESTIONS 26-50 SET 6 of 6

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Part two checkpoints

- **Question 33 by minute 20** of this part.
- **Question 42 by minute 40.**
- **Flag and move at three minutes**; come back at the end.
- Mid-exam fatigue shows as re-reading. Read the question first, then the stem.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> On the real exam, minute 120 should find you near question 50.

A bank processes account events where each customer's events must be handled strictly in order. Events for different customers can be processed in parallel by one pool of workers.

Throughput is about 2,000 events per second.

What should the solutions architect use?

A. An SQS FIFO queue with high throughput mode, using the customer ID as the message group ID

B. A standard SQS queue

C. An SNS standard topic

D. One SQS FIFO queue per customer

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A FIFO, group per customer
Order per customer, parallel across customers.

B Standard queue
No ordering.

C SNS standard
No ordering, no buffering.

D Queue per customer
Millions of queues to manage.

THE SIGNAL

One worker pool, order within a key: FIFO with a message group per key. Module 01.

A multiplayer game sends player position updates over UDP to servers on EC2. It needs very low latency and must preserve client source IP addresses.

Servers run in an Auto Scaling group.

Which load balancer should the solutions architect choose?

A Application Load Balancer

B Network Load Balancer

C Gateway Load Balancer

D API Gateway WebSocket API

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which load balancer should the solutions architect choose?

A ALB
HTTP and HTTPS only.

B NLB
UDP, low latency, preserves source IP.

C GWLB
For inline appliances.

D WebSocket API
TCP-based, adds latency.

THE SIGNAL

Non-HTTP protocols, fixed IPs or PrivateLink all mean NLB. Module 04.

> Forty legacy applications in separate VPCs talk to each other over many TCP and UDP protocols. Some open ports dynamically. They need full IP reachability.
>
> The VPC CIDR ranges do not overlap.

What should the solutions architect use to connect them?

A Amazon VPC Lattice

B PrivateLink endpoint services

C AWS Transit Gateway with route tables

D ECS Service Connect

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use to connect them?

A VPC Lattice

Service-level, not full IP reachability.

B PrivateLink

One service, one direction, per endpoint.

C Transit Gateway

Routes IP traffic between many VPCs.

D Service Connect

ECS only.

THE SIGNAL

Network reachability is Transit Gateway. Service-to-service access with identity is Lattice. Module 04.

A company is adding IPv6 to its VPCs. Instances in private subnets need outbound IPv6 access to internet services, but must not be reachable from the internet.

The team wants the lowest cost.

What should the solutions architect add?

A A NAT gateway

B An internet gateway with a route for ::/0

C A NAT instance

D An egress-only internet gateway

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect add?

A NAT gateway
Charges per GB; not needed for IPv6 to IPv6.

B Internet gateway
Allows inbound connections.

C NAT instance
Servers to run.

D Egress-only gateway
Outbound only, no processing charge.

THE SIGNAL

Private IPv6 traffic to IPv6 destinations: the egress-only gateway, which costs nothing to process. Module 10.

> A reservations database needs 12 read replicas for reporting, failover in well under a minute, and read access from a second Region with low lag.
>
> The application uses MySQL.

Which database should the solutions architect choose?

A. RDS for MySQL Multi-AZ with read replicas

B. Aurora MySQL with an Aurora global database

C. MySQL on EC2 with replication

D. DynamoDB global tables

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which database should the solutions architect choose?

A RDS MySQL
Slower failover; replicas lag more.

B Aurora global database
Up to 15 replicas, fast failover, cross-Region reads.

C Self-managed MySQL
Operations burden.

D DynamoDB
Different data model.

THE SIGNAL

Many readers, fast failover or cross-Region reads point to Aurora. Module 12.

> A gaming leaderboard reads the same DynamoDB items thousands of times per second. The team needs microsecond read latency.
>
> Developers want the smallest possible code change.

What should the solutions architect add?

A DynamoDB Accelerator (DAX)

B ElastiCache with cache-aside logic

C DynamoDB global tables

D More read capacity

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect add?

A DAX
DynamoDB-compatible API, microsecond reads.

B ElastiCache
New caching code to write.

C Global tables
Replication, not latency.

D More capacity
Still single-digit milliseconds.

THE SIGNAL

DynamoDB with minimal code change means DAX. Any other source, or computed results, means ElastiCache. Module 12.

A role in account A can be assumed by an analytics role in account B. The analytics role can list objects in account A's bucket, but every GetObject fails with access denied.

The objects are encrypted with a customer managed KMS key in account A.

What is the MOST likely cause?

A The trust policy is wrong

B The bucket policy denies listing

C The KMS key policy does not allow the role to decrypt

D S3 Block Public Access is enabled

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the MOST likely cause?

A Trust policy

Assumption works, so trust is fine.

B Bucket policy

Listing works.

C KMS key policy

Data access needs the key too.

D Block Public Access

Not public access.

THE SIGNAL

Can list but cannot read encrypted objects: the key policy is the forgotten grant. Module 18.

> An application connects to Aurora PostgreSQL with a password stored in a configuration file. Auditors require the credential to rotate every 30 days with no application outage.
>
> The team wants the least custom code.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A. A Lambda function that changes the password and edits the file

B. Systems Manager Parameter Store with a reminder

C. IAM database authentication with tokens cached for a month

D. AWS Secrets Manager with managed rotation, and the application reading the secret at runtime

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Custom Lambda
Custom rotation code.

B Parameter Store
No rotation.

C IAM auth tokens
Tokens last 15 minutes; caching breaks.

D Secrets Manager rotation
Managed rotation, no outage.

THE SIGNAL

Database credentials rotated automatically: Secrets Manager managed rotation. Module 18.

> A company's internal microservices must authenticate each other with mutual TLS. It needs to issue thousands of private certificates, rotate them often, and control its own certificate hierarchy.
>
> Certificates must not be publicly trusted.

What should the solutions architect use?

A Public certificates from AWS Certificate Manager

B AWS Private CA

C Self-signed certificates on each service

D IAM server certificates

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Public ACM certificates
Publicly trusted; wrong for internal mTLS.

B AWS Private CA
Private hierarchy, issued and rotated at scale.

C Self-signed
No common trust or rotation.

D IAM certificates
Legacy, not for this.

THE SIGNAL

Private certificates for internal mTLS at scale: AWS Private CA. Module 18.

> Security finds an attack coming from a specific address range against instances in one subnet. The range must be blocked immediately at the subnet boundary.
>
> Security groups currently allow HTTPS from anywhere.

What should the solutions architect do?

A Add deny rules for the range to the subnet's network ACL

B Add a deny rule to the security group

C Remove the internet gateway

D Enable GuardDuty

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect do?

A Network ACL deny

NACLs support explicit deny by address.

B Security group deny

Security groups have no deny rules.

C Remove IGW

Takes down all traffic.

D GuardDuty

Detects; does not block.

THE SIGNAL

Block a specific address range now: a network ACL deny. Allow by role or tier: security groups. Module 11.

A company must restrict outbound internet traffic from 30 VPCs to an approved list of domains, such as package repositories. It wants a managed service with the least operational overhead.

No third-party product is required.

What should the solutions architect deploy?

A Squid proxies on EC2

B Security groups with domain names

C AWS Network Firewall in a central egress VPC, with stateful domain list rules

D A Gateway Load Balancer with third-party firewalls

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect deploy?

A Squid proxies

Servers to patch and scale.

B Security groups

Security groups cannot filter by domain.

C Network Firewall

Managed domain allow-listing.

D GWLB appliances

Third-party appliances add work.

THE SIGNAL

Least operational overhead and no named product: AWS Network Firewall. Module 11.

> Contractors need SSH and RDP access to a few dozen EC2 instances in private subnets. The company wants no VPN and no bastion hosts.
>
> Access must depend on user identity and device posture, and every session must be logged.

What should the solutions architect use?

A. A bastion host with key pairs

B. AWS Client VPN

C. Public IP addresses with restricted security groups

D. AWS Verified Access with TCP endpoints

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Bastion

Ruled out.

B Client VPN

Ruled out.

C Public IPs

Exposes instances.

D Verified Access TCP

Identity and posture checks for SSH and RDP.

THE SIGNAL

Per-application access with device posture and no VPN, including non-HTTP: Verified Access. Module 17.

A bank's customer chatbot on Amazon Bedrock must never give investment advice or recommend specific securities, even when asked directly.

Other banking questions must still be answered.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A. A content filter set to high for all categories

B. A guardrail denied topic describing investment advice

C. A word filter listing ticker symbols

D. A system prompt asking the model to refuse

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Content filters
Harmful categories, not a business topic.

B Denied topic
Blocks the topic, allows the rest.

C Word filter
Easily bypassed; incomplete.

D System prompt
Not enforced.

THE SIGNAL

A business topic the assistant must never discuss: a denied topic. Module 24.

A company with 300 accounts suspects many EC2 instances, EBS volumes and Lambda functions are oversized. It wants rightsizing recommendations based on actual utilisation, across the organisation.

It wants the least effort.

What should the solutions architect use?

A. A script reading CloudWatch metrics in each account

B. AWS Trusted Advisor

C. AWS Compute Optimizer with organisation-wide opt-in

D. Cost Explorer filtered by service

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A Custom script

Builds a recommender by hand.

B Trusted Advisor

Off the in-scope list; fewer resource types.

C Compute Optimizer

Utilisation-based recommendations, org-wide.

D Cost Explorer

Shows spend, not sizing.

THE SIGNAL

Rightsizing from real utilisation across an organisation: Compute Optimizer. Module 26.

A DynamoDB table holds eight years of order history. Storage is now 80 percent of the table's cost, and old items are rarely read.

The table must remain online and queryable.

What should the solutions architect do?

A Switch to on-demand capacity

B Add DAX

C Export to S3 and delete the table

D Change the table class to DynamoDB Standard-Infrequent Access

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect do?

A On-demand
Throughput pricing, not storage.

B DAX
Adds cost.

C Export and delete
No longer online.

D Standard-IA class
Lower storage price, same API.

THE SIGNAL

Storage-dominated DynamoDB tables: the Standard-Infrequent Access table class. Module 31.

A software company lets customers worldwide download 50 TB of installers a month directly from an S3 bucket. Data transfer out is its largest AWS cost.

Downloads are mostly the same few files.

What should the solutions architect do?

A Put a CloudFront distribution in front of the bucket

B Enable S3 Transfer Acceleration

C Replicate the bucket to every Region

D Move the files to EFS

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect do?

A CloudFront
Caches popular files; lower delivery cost.

B Transfer Acceleration
Adds a charge.

C Replicate everywhere
Multiplies storage and still pays transfer.

D EFS
Not for public downloads.

THE SIGNAL

Popular objects downloaded worldwide: serve them through CloudFront. Module 28.

A marketplace classifies 50 million product listings a day into categories with a large Bedrock model. Quality is good, but cost is too high.

The task is narrow and the same every day.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Intelligent prompt routing

B Model distillation, training a smaller model on the larger model's outputs for this task

C Provisioned Throughput for the large model

D Shorter prompts only

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Prompt routing
Suits mixed difficulty.

B Distillation
Small, cheap model at near-teacher quality.

C Provisioned Throughput
Capacity, not a cheaper model.

D Shorter prompts
Modest savings.

THE SIGNAL

Mixed difficulty, no training: routing. One narrow task at huge volume: distillation. Module 27.

> An airline wants to modernise its mainframe crew-scheduling system. It wants to keep the business rules but redesign the batch jobs into event-driven services on AWS.
>
> A line-by-line conversion to Java is not wanted.

Which approach should the solutions architect recommend?

A Refactor COBOL to Java with AWS Transform

B Rehost on an emulator

C Replatform onto a managed runtime

D Reimagine with AWS Transform, extracting business rules and redesigning the architecture

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which approach should the solutions architect recommend?

A Refactor

Line-by-line conversion, ruled out.

B Rehost

Keeps COBOL and batch.

C Replatform

Keeps the design; runtime closed to new customers.

D Reimagine

Keeps the rules, changes the design.

THE SIGNAL

Keep what it decides, change how it works: reimagine. Module 36.

A company uses AWS Elastic Disaster Recovery for 200 servers. Auditors require a recovery test every quarter.

The test must not affect production or interrupt replication.

What should the solutions architect do?

A Fail over production to AWS each quarter

B Stop replication, test, then restart it

C Launch drill instances in Elastic Disaster Recovery into an isolated test VPC

D Restore from AWS Backup instead

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect do?

A Real failover
Risks production.

B Pause replication
Creates an RPO gap.

C DRS drill
Tests recovery while replication continues.

D AWS Backup restore
Tests a different mechanism.

THE SIGNAL

Test DR without touching production: a drill in an isolated network. Module 38.

> A company backs up 2,000 resources with AWS Backup. Auditors want regular evidence that backups can actually be restored, not just that they exist.
>
> The team wants this automated.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A. An AWS Backup restore testing plan that restores sampled recovery points on a schedule and validates them

B. A manual restore once a year

C. More frequent backups

D. Backup vault lock

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Restore testing
Automated, scheduled restore evidence.

B Yearly manual restore
Infrequent and manual.

C More backups
More backups, still untested.

D Vault lock
Protects, does not test.

THE SIGNAL

Prove backups restore, automatically: AWS Backup restore testing. Module 39.

> A security team has written 30 new CloudFormation Guard Hook rules. Nobody knows how many existing stacks would fail them.
>
> The team must enforce the rules without suddenly breaking delivery pipelines.

How should the rules be rolled out?

A Activate all rules in fail mode at once

B Ask teams to test locally

C Apply the rules to new accounts only

D Activate the Hooks in warn mode, review invocation results, fix findings, then switch to fail mode

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the rules be rolled out?

A Fail mode at once
Breaks many pipelines.

B Local testing
Voluntary, no central view.

C New accounts only
Leaves existing risk.

D Warn, then fail
Measures impact, then enforces.

THE SIGNAL

New enforcement rules: warn mode first, results reviewed, then fail. Module 41.

A new ECS service on Fargate communicates with other services through ECS Service Connect. The team wants canary releases, a bake time before the old revision is removed, and alarm-based rollback.

It wants as few additional services as possible.

What should the solutions architect use?

A CodeDeploy blue/green for ECS

B The ECS built-in deployment controller with a canary strategy

C Rolling updates with the circuit breaker

D Two services behind Route 53 weighted records

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect use?

A CodeDeploy

No Service Connect support; extra service.

B ECS built-in canary

Canary, bake time, rollback, Service Connect.

C Rolling

No traffic slice or bake time.

D Route 53 weights

Custom and imprecise.

THE SIGNAL

New ECS service, or Service Connect: the built-in deployment controller. Module 44.

> Operators for 70 accounts switch roles between accounts during incidents to read metrics, logs and traces.
>
> They want one place to search all three signals across accounts, without copying data.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Subscription filters to a central account

B Dashboards in each account

C CloudWatch cross-account observability with a monitoring account

D OpenSearch with all logs copied in

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Subscriptions
Copies logs only.

B Per-account dashboards
Still switching roles.

C Cross-account observability
All signals, viewed in place.

D OpenSearch
Copies data; a cluster to run.

THE SIGNAL

Look across accounts: cross-account observability. Move the data somewhere: subscriptions. Module 45.

> A lender's credit model on a SageMaker AI endpoint passed a fairness review at launch. A regulator now requires scheduled evidence that approval outcomes are not drifting against applicants over 60.
>
> Results must be recorded automatically.

What should the solutions architect implement?

A. A Model Monitor bias drift schedule using SageMaker Clarify

B. A data quality monitor on the age feature

C. Remove the age feature

D. A yearly manual review

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect implement?

A Bias drift monitor
Scheduled bias metrics for the group.

B Data quality on age
Watches inputs, not outcomes.

C Remove age
Proxies can still carry bias; no evidence.

D Yearly review
Infrequent and manual.

THE SIGNAL

Ongoing evidence that outcomes stay fair to a group: a bias drift monitor. Module 47.

> Checkout and a nightly data import run as Lambda functions in the same account. Last night the import scaled to the account concurrency limit, and checkout requests were throttled.
>
> Checkout must always have capacity.

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Provisioned concurrency on the import

B Reserved concurrency for checkout, and a maximum concurrency on the import's event source

C A higher account limit only

D Move checkout to another Region

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the solutions architect configure?

A Provisioned on import

Wrong function; no cap.

B Reserved and capped

Checkout keeps a share; import is bounded.

C Higher limit only

Import can grow into it.

D Another Region

A large change for isolation.

THE SIGNAL

One workload starving another: a bulkhead with reserved and capped concurrency. Module 48.

Part two: score and next steps

RESULT ON THESE 25	WHAT TO DO
20 or more	On track. Continue to part three
16 to 19	Passing range but thin. Review misses first
12 to 15	Rewatch the modules named in your misses
Below 12	Return to the domain papers for weak domains
Worse than part one	Likely fatigue: practise full sittings
Over 60 minutes	Practise pacing with the checkpoints

ON THE EXAM

Compare with part one. A drop in the middle of a long sitting is common, and practice fixes it.